Q15: Discussion Questions

DLS 2026 — Kukla

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1. Attention is $O(n^2)$ and the KV cache is $O(n)$. For a very long document, which becomes the binding constraint first in practice, and how does that shape serving decisions?
2. RAG reduces hallucination by grounding answers in retrieved text. What new failure modes does it introduce, and how would you detect them?
3. "Lost in the middle" shows models use the start and end of a long context better than the middle. What does this imply for how you order retrieved chunks?
4. Context is volatile and weights are fixed, so where should a long-term personal assistant store what it learns about a user—and what are the privacy consequences?
5. When would you pay for a 1M-token context instead of building a retrieval system, and vice versa? Give concrete decision criteria.